

Mobile watch

Android and Reliance unite; what's in it for you? HTC's 3 new phones. Sony's 1st phone since it began flying solo

App watch

Enjoy the iPad's Retina Display on the newest iPad doing the rounds with these updated game titles

Google+ gets facelift, claims to be “more functional and flexible” than ever

Google+ has had a makeover, and there are now plenty of new features, right from a redesigned navigation and Hangout interface to new Explore and Profile pages. The navigation interface sees previously static icons replaced by a dynamic ribbon, which can be used to bookmark and manage applications as well as perform quick-actions.

The new Hangout homepage allows you to view a list of all invitations, get pro tips and provides quick access to public and on-air hangouts with a carousel of popular hangouts to choose from. Looks nice.



The updated Profile page now features much bigger photos, while the new Explore page will display most trending topics across each user's Google+ network. The chat interface has been rede-



signed as well, prioritising important contacts.

Google says the new design will help generate lively conversations, with users now able to share “full bleed” photos and videos, monitor an activity



drawer surround your uploading content and browse conversation cards to view discussions.

Would these changes make you want to switch from another social network cough* Facebook cough*. Write in and tell us. **d**

Facebook wants to be like Google

Facebook is reportedly overhauling its search functionality to compete with Google, a move that could intensify rivalry between the two web giants even further. Reports tell us that about 24 Facebook developers, led by ex-Google engineer Lars Rasmussen, are working on a new search engine module.

The engine is likely to allow users to more easily browse Facebook status updates, notes, images and videos. Facebook aims to keep its users from jumping off its social network to use Google's search engine for browsing other information.



At this point, you're probably wondering that if Facebook is trying to focus primarily on giving users more access to content already available on its site, how it is competition to the God of Search Engines. Here's how: it's being speculated that the

social network plans to sell keyword ads, very much like

Google and Bing do. It's going to be a rough ride for Facebook though, seeing how it has to ensure optimum privacy settings of users, as it can only integrate those results that a user has set for public viewing. **d**

BSNL's hosted cloud services take flight

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL), in collaboration with IT solutions provider Dimension Data, has launched as many as six internet data centres across the country. It hopes to tap the growing demand for hosted and cloud services by government organisations and private firms.

As a part of a 10-year-revenue share agreement, Dimension Data will operate and manage BSNL's data centres located in cities namely Mumbai, Faridabad, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Ludhiana and Ghaziabad. State-run organisations such as Employees Provident Fund Organisation, Indian Oil Corporation Limited and Punjab Treasuries have already started

using BSNL's data centres on a pilot basis.

RK Upadhyay, chairman and managing director, BSNL, said, “With the launch of our data centres, we can offer secure hosted and cloud services to support various government initiatives as well as to our enterprise clients. We expect to sign more contracts from state and central government departments as well as several private enterprises shortly”. BSNL is said to also be eyeing distance education providers, private enterprise and defence services. **d**

